and its promise. Transcending ideological and political differences, without losing our individual identities, we all coalesced for the shared goal of safeguarding our beloved nation's core values in the face of unprecedented assault.

Inspired by the sacrifices of Mahatma Gandhi and Bhagat Singh, and the vision of Dr Bhimrao Ambedkar, the Communist Party of India joined the Yatra to transcend the divisions and strife created by the BJP and heal the nation. In times when a new political situation is threatening the very survival of democracy, we came together for the greater good and joined the Yatra to inject fresh life into the constitutional values of liberty, equality, fraternity and justice. I witnessed this in Srinagar, where many Kashmiris braved the biting cold and snow to come out in solidarity with the cause we were fighting for. We all stood with the neglected and marginalized sections of society and with our disempowered fellow citizens, year after year in the past decade. The Yatra became a platform for these sections and it was overwhelming to see them coming out on to the streets to protect the values that define us. All sensitive and patriotic Indians received a morale boost from the Yatra's message.

To see the palpable plight of our fellow Indians makes me think back angrily at how much havoc the BJP's misgovernance has caused. Policies such as demonetization have broken the informal sector. An anti-federal GST and partisan tax devolution has robbed states of legitimate resources for development work. The labour codes have disempowered workers' rights and freedoms. Economic mismanagement has given rise to historic unemployment, and the mishandling of the Covid-19 crisis killed millions. Favouring crony capitalists has proved detrimental to the social sector. And this has been exacerbated by the BJP's divisive politics. The repercussions of this divisive politics are visible nationwide. No conscientious Indian is allowed to raise their voice or even show a mirror to the government without being branded antinational or an urban Naxal. The survival of democracy in the country has become a paramount concern, contextualizing the formation of the Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance (INDIA).